

Board of Works April 29, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a1JH94hXfLE
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Muncie Board of Public Works and Safety <U+2014> Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: April 29, 2024

Board Name: Muncie Board of Public Works and Safety

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting to order at [00:00:16](#), identifying it as the April 29th meeting of the Muncie Board of Public Works and Safety, held on the "last Wednesday of April."
- **Attendance:**
 - Members Present: Mr. Baker, Mr. Melcher, and Mr. Wysong.
 - Members Absent: None noted.
 - Presiding Officer: Mr. Wysong (implied by leading roll call and proceedings).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance ([00:00:25](#)).

- **Approval of Minutes:** The board reviewed and approved the minutes from the April 22nd meeting (Approved by Voice Vote, [00:00:54](#)).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:11 Register of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Craig presented the register of claims, noting a heavy volume of healthcare claims and the payment of second-quarter 911 fees to the Delaware County auditor. Board members emphasized the extensive review work conducted prior to the meeting. The board also noted that the city pays Delaware County property taxes on certain properties.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote for \$1,695,975.99 ([00:02:34](#)).
- **00:03:01 Street Closure Application: The Woodlands Car Show**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Bailey Maxwell (representing The Woodlands)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The applicant requested a street closure on an extended section of Jackson Street from one end of the building to the other for a car show celebrating Father's Day on June 20th, aimed at ensuring public safety for attendees.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote ([00:03:48](#)).
- **00:04:12 Make My Move Program Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ryan Pike and Amber (Make My Move)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presenters provided an annual update on the online marketplace partnership, which recruits remote and local-employment workers to Muncie. Over a 4-year partnership, 92 households (approx. 225 individuals) have relocated. The agreement total is \$175,000 (funded via EDIT and matched 1-to-1 by the state/IDC). Eligibility includes any address with a Muncie zip code (via an interlocal agreement with the Delaware County Redevelopment Commission) and now extends to individuals acquiring employment in Muncie or Delaware County, rather than strictly remote workers.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote ([00:07:47](#)).
- **00:08:51 Muncie Mission Ministries Corporate Warranty Deed and Sales Disclosure**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Amber
 - **Deliberation Summary:** This item involves the transfer of property parcels containing the Industry Church from the Muncie Mission to the city.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote ([00:09:32](#)).
- **00:10:00 Authorization for Purchase and Financing of Forestry Equipment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Adam (City Engineer)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The city received a \$1.8 million grant from the USDA Forestry Service to clear invasive and damaged trees and expand the urban canopy,

which includes hiring and training staff and an arborist. Because grant rules stipulate leasing rather than purchasing capital equipment, the board authorized a four-year lease totaling \$274,434 for a Freightliner forestry truck (with a chipper bed and telescopic boom), a Vermeer chipper, and a Vermeer stump grinder via pre-negotiated Sourcewell pricing from Altec.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:12:28).
- 00:13:00 **2026 Demolition Bid Contracts**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Courtney Walker (Muncie Building Commissioner's office)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The office presented low bids for upcoming property demolitions:
 - *218 E 7th Street:* Yarberry Construction, \$10,888 (owner agreed to a payment plan).
 - *1900 block West 17th Street & 1924 West 17th Street:* J.A. Schwoerer Group, \$4,925.
 - *906 South Beacon Street:* J.A. Schwoerer Group, \$5,920 (owner discussion ongoing).
 - *611 South Council Street:* Schwoerer Solutions, \$9,215.
 - *928 South E Bright Street:* Steve Excavating and Demo, \$4,100 (owner discussion ongoing).
 - *2523 adjacent South Mingo Avenue:* Yarberry Construction, \$2,491. Funding primarily originates from Community Development HUD funds, while historical properties are covered by the unsafe building hearing fund.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:15:31).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 00:15:55 **Rick Yencer** (Resident / Self-identified News Man Otter) spoke regarding:
 - The Muncie Mission deed transfer (Industry Church near the 12th Street Cafe), questioning the city's intended use and noting past community discussions around a South Muncie community center.
 - Concerns regarding ongoing operating expense payments for the crisis center appearing on claims.
 - Broader concerns about the city engaging in real estate management and the acquisition of property by outside entities, as well as the overall cost to taxpayers.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Presiding officer reminded attendees that paperwork could be signed immediately following adjournment.

- **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned following the public comment period (00:17:19).

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